NOW, MEN BLING IT ON

Urban men across India are taking to jewels not just for ceremonial but everyday use. Spurred by celebrity adoption and dedicated product lines, the burgeoning male jewellery segment now constitutes 10-15 per cent of the overall jewellery market

By JUMANA SHAH

When Akshay Jhawar, 36, a textiles exporter in Surat, walked into a private jewellery show last year looking for some glint, he itched for something radical, something that quietly announced his personality to every room he walked into, unfettered by the shirt-and-tie decorum of formal society. The only jewellery he had worn since birth was a gold ring on his ear—a community ritual—and he wanted something more assertive. Venus Jewels, the diamond and solitaire exporters that had organised the show, had done so reluctantly, too, unconvinced by the profitability of male jewellery for anything other than ceremonial purchases. The industry truism, after all, was that men buy, women wear.

₹1.3 lakh crore
Size of India's male jewellery market, which grew 25-30% year-on-year in 2025

But that's not true anymore.

"I don't have words for it," says Jhawar, sporting a bright stud he fell in love with at the display. "I felt like I had found my soulmate. When I come in somewhere wearing a solitaire, I feel like I own the room." His surprise is echoed by Akshat Shah, partner at Venus Jewels. "It was truly an eye-opener. We underestimated the demand for men's jewellery," he says. The pieces on display that day, costing anywhere from Rs 2 lakh to Rs 2 crore, were "lapped up", he says, "and people wanted more!"

Jhawar is far from the only man in Indian cities taking to jewellery for everyday use. He and others like him are reviving a norm of beauty that saw its heyday with the sultans and maharajas of South Asia and declined with the arrival of European colonialism: jewellery on men. Movie stars, cricketers and musicians are seen flaunting rings and chains that convey the same ideals as those forebears—wealth, power and virility—mixed with a subtle, modern cosmopolitanism. A platinum bracelet serves the same purpose as a *kada*—"the strength to overcome any obstacle"—for Aviral Kukreja, 39, a capital markets investor eyeing a natty neck chain.

Politicians have long flashed a ring or two, a gold chain too, to

